Cookies on GOV.UK Design System

We'd like to use analytics cookies so we can understand how you use the Design System and make improvements.

We also use essential cookies to remember if you've accepted analytics cookies.

Accept analytics cookies | Reject analytics cookies | View cookies (/cookies/)

Accordion (/components/accordion/)

Back link (/components/back-link/)

Breadcrumbs (/components/breadcrumbs/)

Button (/components/button/)

Character count (/components/character-count/)

Checkboxes (/components/checkboxes/)

Cookie banner (/components/cookie-banner/)

Date input (/components/date-input/)

Details (/components/details/)

Error message (/components/error-message/)

Error summary (/components/error-summary/)

Exit this page (/components/exit-this-page/)

Feedback (/components/feedback/)

Fieldset (/components/fieldset/)

File upload (/components/file-upload/)

Generic header (/components/generic-header/)

GOV.UK footer (/components/footer/)

GOV.UK header (/components/header/)

Inset text (/components/inset-text/)

Language navigation (/components/language-navigation/)

Notification banner

Use a notification banner to tell the user about something they need to know about, but that's not directly related to the page content.

Open this example in a new tab (/components/notification-banner/default/)

Important

You have 7 days left to send your application. View application.

HTML Nunjucks

When to use this component

A notification banner lets you tell the user about something that's not directly relevant to the thing they're trying to do on that page of the service. For example:

- telling the user about a problem that's affecting the service as a whole (for example, delays in processing applications because of an emergency)
- telling the user about something that affects them in particular (for example, an approaching deadline they need to meet)
- telling the user about the outcome of something they've just done on a previous page (for example, confirming that an email has been sent)

When not to use this component

Use notification banners sparingly. There's evidence that people often miss them (https://www.nngroup.com/articles/banner-blindness-old-and-new-findings/), and using them too often is likely to make this problem worse.

If the information is directly relevant to the thing the user is doing on that page, put the information in the main page content instead. Use an Inset text component (/components/inset-text/) or Warning text component (/components/warning-text/) if it needs to stand out.

Do not:

Notification banner (/components/notification-banner/)

History (/components/notification-banner/history/)

Use with Nunjucks (/components/notification-banner/nunjucks/)

Pagination (/components/pagination/)

Panel (/components/panel/)

Password input (/components/password-input/)

Phase banner (/components/phase-banner/)

Radios (/components/radios/)

Select (/components/select/)

Service navigation (/components/service-navigation/)

Skip link (/components/skip-link/)

Summary list (/components/summary-list/)

Table (/components/table/)

Tabs (/components/tabs/)

Tag (/components/tag/)

Task list (/components/task-list/)

Text input (/components/text-input/)

Textarea (/components/textarea/)

Warning text (/components/warning-text/)

- use a notification banner to tell the user about validation errors - use an Error message component (/components/error-message/) and Error summary component (/components/error-summary/) instead
- show a notification banner and an Error summary component (/components/error-summary/) on the same page - just show the error summary

How it works

Position a notification banner immediately before the page `h1`. The notification banner should be the same width as the page's other content, such as components, headings and body text. For example, if the other content takes up two-thirds of the screen on desktop devices, then the notification banner should also take up two-thirds. Read about how to lay out pages (/styles/layout/).

Use `role="region"` and `aria-labelledby="govuk-notification-banner-title"` (with `id="govuk-notification-banner-title"` on `<govuk-notification-banner__title>`) so that screen reader users can navigate to the notification banner.

Avoid showing more than one notification banner on the same page. Instead, combine the messages in a single notification banner. If the messages are too different to combine, only show the highest priority notification banner.

Notification banner headings

You can use `<h3>` headings in the `govuk-notification-banner__content` to help structure your content.

Avoid using headings for single-line notifications that do not need them.

Telling the user about a problem that affects the whole service

Use a 'neutral' blue notification banner if the user needs to know about a problem with the service as a whole.

For example:

- in a service that lets the user register or apply for something, they might need to know that it's taking longer than usual to process applications because of an emergency
- in an account-type service, the user might need to know that the service will be down for scheduled maintenance

Open this example in a new tab (/components/notification-banner/whole-service/)

Important

There may be a delay in processing your application because of the coronavirus outbreak.

HTML Nunjucks

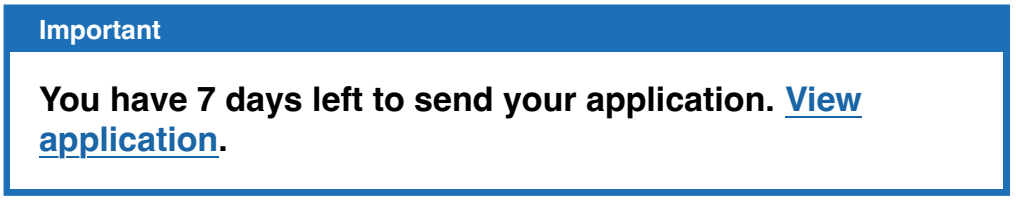
If your service is on GOV.UK and it's affected by an emergency, ask your department's content team to make a request to add a downtime message on GOV.UK content that links to it (https://guidance.publishing.service.gov.uk/accounts-support/make-content-requests/ask-downtime-messages/).
If your service is getting more demand than usual, check that you've set up There is a problem with the service pages (/patterns/problem-with-the-service-pages/) and Service unavailable pages (/patterns/service-unavailable-pages/), and the wording is up to date.

Telling the user about something that's happening elsewhere

Use a 'neutral' notification banner if the user needs to know about something that's happening elsewhere in the service. For example:

- in a case working system, the user might need to know that there are new cases waiting for their attention
- in an account-type service, you might need to tell the user that there's a deadline approaching or that a payment is overdue

Open this example in a new tab (/components/notification-banner/default/)



HTML Nunjucks

Reacting to something the user has done

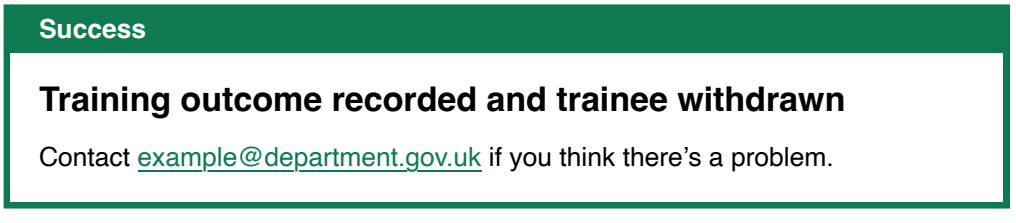
You can also use a notification banner to tell the user about the outcome of something they've just done - but they have not finished the current journey, so it does not make sense to use a Confirmation page at this point in your service (/patterns/confirmation-pages/).

Using a notification banner is unlikely to be the right approach in a linear service - for example, a service that lets the user register or apply for a thing. For a linear service, it will usually make sense to stick to the 'one thing per page' approach (https://www.gov.uk/service-manual/design/form-structure), and avoid using a notification banner.

Use a Confirmation page in a linear service (/patterns/confirmation-pages/) to tell users that they've finished using the service instead of a notification banner.

Use the green version of the notification banner to confirm that something they're expecting to happen has happened.

Open this example in a new tab (/components/notification-banner/success/)



HTML Nunjucks

Since you're using the notification banner to tell the user about the outcome of something they've just done, add `role="alert"` so focus shifts to the notification

banner on page load.

Remove a green notification banner when the user moves to a new page.

To make the green version of the notification banner accessible:

- use headings like 'Success' - so that you're not relying on colour alone to convey meaning – to meet WCAG 2.2 success criterion 1.4.1 Use of colour (https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/use-of-color.html)
- use the same heading for green notification banners within the same service - so that you're identifying components that work in the same way consistently – this is to meet WCAG 2.2 success criterion 3.2.4 Consistent identification (https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/consistent-identification)

Research on this component

We need more research to understand:

- how common it is for users to miss important information in notification banners (including users of assistive technology, who might skip straight to the `h1`)
- whether it's sometimes helpful to allow users to dismiss notifications, and how to do this

Recent changes

Date	Changed	Description
Aug 2022	v4.3.0 (https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-frontend/releases/tag/v4.3.0)	Added the ability to pass the `html` parameter using Nunjucks call syntax (https://mozilla.github.io/nunjucks/templating.html#call).
Sept 2021	Guidance	Added more detailed guidance on where to position the notification banner on a page.
Feb 2021	Guidance	Added advice on how and when to use heading HTML tags in the component.
Dec 2020	v3.10.1 (https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-frontend/releases/tag/v3.10.1)	Fixed small gap between header and outer border. Explicitly set component's text colour. Updated component to wrap text at two thirds of `width-container` width.
Nov 2020	v3.10.0 (https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-frontend/releases/tag/v3.10.0)	Component introduced.

View full change history (/components/notification-banner/history/)

Help improve this component

To help make sure that this page is useful, relevant and up to date, you can:

- take part in the 'Notification banner' discussion on GitHub (https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-design-system/discussions/6121/) and share your research
- propose a change on GitHub (https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-design-system/edit/main/src/components/notification-banner/index.md) – read more about how to propose changes in GitHub (/community/propose-a-content-change-using-github/)

Need help?

↑ Back to top

If you've got a question about the GOV.UK Design System, contact the team (/contact/).

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